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INDIA TODAY RPG Happiness Quest

HAPPINESS MANTRA

"Being happy is important. Only when you are happy can you make others happy"

"Be more action-oriented than result-oriented"

By **MATA AMRITANANDAMAYI**

Just like any other decision, happiness is also a decision. You need to tell yourself that whatever happens in life, you will be happy, you will be strong, because you are not alone; the whole universe, the power of God is with you. Whether we laugh or cry, the days will pass.

Happiness is our true nature. So, whether it is you or anyone else, happiness is everything, it is the very purpose of life. It is purely subjective, but its outer experience comes when we cultivate a mind that remains unperturbed, no matter what changes take place in the external world.

We ourselves are the only source of happiness in the world. If happiness were really rooted in worldly objects, everyone would get happiness from those. We have to understand this truth—happiness is not in objects, it is within us. We are the one source of happiness. This understanding itself can help us gain control over our desires. In turn, we will become more peaceful and experience our own inner joy.

We are born to experience happiness and we live our lives struggling to attain it. The tragedy is that most of us die without ever truly experiencing it. Moreover, we can only give others what we have. If we are unhappy, we will be able to share only unhappiness with others. To be happy is most important because only happy people can be successful—both in their personal and professional life.

These are a few tips on how to be happy:

• Be content with yourself: It doesn't mean curbing your ambition or to stop earning, but being content with what you possess

• Be selfless: Don't be just a taker but a giver too. Earn as much as you wish, but learn to return as much as you can to society. Look beyond your own family to the world.

• Follow dharma: It means a life of values such as truthfulness, kindness, and showing others respect

• Be more action-oriented than result-oriented: When you are anxious about the result of a particular action, it not only prevents you from utilising your full potential but also affects the outcome of the action. On the other hand, when you are completely focused on the action, it helps you tap into your inner capabilities, bringing out the best in you.

• Give equal importance to logic and faith: Create a balance between the head and the heart. It means the external world of objectivity and the inner world of subjective reality, the mystery aspect of life.

• Meditate and pray for God's grace, for the support and blessing of the whole, of which we are only parts. ■

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